Siratul Jinan — Surah Al-Fatihah

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Surah Al-Fatihah: English Translation

Ayat 1:1

Arabic: اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِيْنَۙ(1)

Translation: All praise is due to Allah, the Owner of all the worlds.

{اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ: All praise is due to Allah.} That is, Allah Almighty is deserving of every kind of praise and commendation, because Allah Almighty encompasses all perfect attributes.

Definition of Praise and Gratitude

Praise means commending someone on account of their voluntary qualities, whereas gratitude means honouring someone with the tongue, heart, or limbs in return for their favour. Since we generally praise Allah Almighty with His favours in view, this praise of ours is also gratitude.

The Virtues of Praising Allah Almighty

Many virtues of praising and glorifying Allah Almighty have been mentioned in the hadith. Three of them are given below:

1. Sayyiduna Anas ibn Malik رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُ narrates that the Noble Prophet ﷺ said, “Allah Almighty is pleased with a servant who praises Allah Almighty after eating something and praises Allah Almighty after drinking something.” (Muslim, Book of Remembrance and Supplication, chapter on the desirability of praising Allah, p. 1463, hadith 89 (2734).)

1. Sayyiduna Jabir ibn Abdullah رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُ narrates that the Illuminated Presence ﷺ said, “The most excellent remembrance is ‘لَآ اِلٰــہَ اِلَّا اللّٰہُ’, and the most excellent supplication is ‘اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰہِ’.” (Ibn Majah, Book of Manners, chapter on the virtue of those who praise, 4/248, hadith 3800.)

1. Sayyiduna Anas ibn Malik رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُ narrates that the Esteemed Presence ﷺ said, “When Allah Almighty bestows a favour upon His servant and he says ‘اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰہِ’

upon receiving the favour, this praise is better in the sight of Allah Almighty than the favour that was given." (Ibn Majah, Book of Manners, chapter on the virtue of those who praise, 4/250, hadith 3805.)

The Islamic Ruling Concerning Praise

Praising Allah is obligatory in a sermon, recommended after eating, Sunnah after sneezing, forbidden after committing a forbidden act, and disbelief in some circumstances.

{لِلّٰهِ: For Allah.} "Allah" is the majestic name of the Exalted Being Who encompasses all perfect attributes. Some exegetes have also stated meanings for this word. One meaning is "the One deserving worship"; another is "the Being before Whose knowledge intellects are bewildered"; a third is "the Being in Whose court tranquillity is attained"; and a fourth is "the Being Whose refuge is sought at a time of hardship." (Baydawi, Al-Fatihah, 1/32.)

{رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِیْنَ: The Owner of all the worlds.} The word "Rabb" has several meanings, such as master, owner, deity, constant, reformer, and the One Who gradually brings something to the level of perfection. Everything that exists

besides Allah Almighty is called a world, and all creation is included in this. (Sawi, Al-Fatihah, under verse 1, 1/16; Khazin, Al-Fatihah, under verse 1, 1/17, excerpted.)

Ayat 1:2

Arabic: الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيْمِۙ(2)

Translation: The Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.

{اَلرَّحْمٰنْ: The Most Gracious.} Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahim are two attributive names of Allah Almighty. Ar-Rahman means the Being Who bestows blessings and shows very great mercy, while Ar-Rahim means the One Who shows abundant mercy.

Remember that, in reality, the Being Who bestows blessings is Allah Almighty. He alone is the Being Who does not demand compensation for His mercy. Allah Almighty alone bestows every small and great, outward and inward, physical and spiritual, worldly and Hereafter-related blessing. Whatever blessing reaches anyone in the world is from the mercy of Allah Almighty, because creating the feeling of

mercy in someone's heart, granting the ability to show mercy, bringing the blessing into existence, enabling another person to benefit from it, and granting sound limbs with which to benefit are all from Allah Almighty alone.

One Should Not Become Bold in Sin Because of Allah Almighty's Vast Mercy

Abu Abdullah Muhammad ibn Ahmad al-Qurtubi رَحْمَۃُاللہِ تَعَالٰی عَلَیْہِ states: Allah Almighty mentioned His two attributes, Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahim, after "رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِیْنَ". The reason is that when Allah Almighty declared that He is the Lord of all the worlds, this produced fear in the heart of the listener and reader because of Allah Almighty's majesty. Along with this, His two attributes, Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahim, were mentioned, and within them there is encouragement to obey Allah Almighty. Thus, both warning and encouragement were stated, so that a servant becomes properly inclined towards obeying Allah Almighty and makes a strong effort to refrain from disobeying Him. (Qurtubi, Al-Fatihah, under verse 2, 1/129, part one.)

In the Holy Quran, Allah Almighty's mercy and His punishment have also been mentioned together clearly in other places. Allah Almighty says:

“وَ اَنَّ عَذَابِیْ هُوَ الْعَذَابُ الْاَلِیْمُ (۴۹)نَبِّئْ عِبَادِیْۤ اَنِّیْۤ اَنَا الْغَفُوْرُ الرَّحِیْمُۙ” (Al-Hijr: 49–50)

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “Inform My servants that undoubtedly I alone am the Most Forgiving, Most Merciful. And undoubtedly My punishment is the painful punishment.”

And He says: “لَاۤ اِلٰهَ اِلَّا -ذِی الطَّوْلِؕ-غَافِرِ الذَّنْۢبِ وَ قَابِلِ التَّوْبِ شَدِیْدِ الْعِقَابِۙ اِلَیْهِ الْمَصِیْرُ-هُوَۚ” (Ghafir: 3)

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “The One Who forgives sins and accepts repentance, Who severely punishes and bestows great bounty. There is no deity besides Him; towards Him is the return.”

It is also narrated from Sayyiduna Abu Hurayrah رَضِیَ اللهُ تَعَالٰی عَنْهُ that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, “If a believer knew how much punishment Allah Almighty has, no one would hope for His Paradise; and if a disbeliever knew how much mercy Allah Almighty has, no one would despair of His

Paradise.” (Muslim, Book of Repentance, chapter on the vastness of Allah's mercy, p. 1473, hadith 23 (2755).) Therefore, every Muslim should remain between hope and fear. He should not become bold in sins upon seeing the vastness of Allah Almighty's mercy, nor should he despair of Allah Almighty's mercy upon seeing the severity of His punishment.

The Ruling Concerning Calling Someone Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahim

It is not permissible to call anyone besides Allah Almighty “Ar-Rahman”, whereas someone may be called “Rahim”. Allah Almighty has also called His Beloved ﷺ Rahim in the Holy Quran. He says:

“لَقَدْ جَآءَكُمْ رَسُوْلٌ مِّنْ اَنْفُسِكُمْ عَزِیْزٌ عَلَیْهِ مَا عَنِتُّمْ حَرِیْصٌ عَلَیْكُمْ بِالْمُؤْمِنِیْنَ رَءُوْفٌ رَّحِیْمٌ” (At-Tawbah: 128)

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “Undoubtedly, there has come to you a Noble Messenger from among you, your falling into difficulty is hard upon him, he ardently desires your well-being, and he is extremely compassionate and merciful towards the Muslims.”

Ayat 1:3

Arabic: مٰلِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّيْنِ(3)ۙ

Translation: The Owner of the Day of Recompense.

{مٰلِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّيْنِ: The Owner of the Day of Recompense.} The Day of Recompense refers to the Day of Judgement. On that day, righteous Muslims will receive reward, while sinners and disbelievers will receive punishment. “Owner” means one who may exercise authority over the things in his ownership as he wishes. Although Allah Almighty is the Owner of both this world and the Hereafter, the Day of Judgement has been mentioned specifically here so that its importance may settle in the heart.

The manifestation of Allah Almighty's ownership will also be greater in the Hereafter than in this world, because on that day no one will possess the apparent sovereignty that Allah Almighty had granted people in the world. For this reason, ownership of the Day of Judgement has been mentioned here specifically.

Ayat 1:4

Arabic: اِیَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَ اِیَّاكَ نَسْتَعِیْنُ(4)

Translation: You alone may we worship, and from You alone may we seek help.

{اِیَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَ اِیَّاكَ نَسْتَعِیْنُ: You alone may we worship, and from You alone may we seek help.} The preceding verses stated that Allah Almighty is truly deserving of every kind of praise and glorification, and that He is the Lord of all the worlds, the Most Gracious, and the Most Merciful. This verse teaches servants to express their servitude in the court of Allah Almighty in these words: “O Allah عَزَّوَجَلَّ, we worship only You, because only You are deserving of worship. No one besides You is worthy of being worshipped, and You alone are the true Helper. Without Your permission and will, no one can provide any kind of outward, inward, physical, spiritual, small, or great help to anyone.”

The Difference Between Worship and Reverence

The meaning of worship is very clear. It is enough to understand that considering someone worthy of worship and showing them any kind of reverence is called worship. If someone is not considered worthy of worship, it is merely reverence and is not worship. For example, standing with one's hands folded in prayer is worship; but standing with one's hands folded, like in prayer, before a teacher, spiritual guide, or parents is merely reverence and is not worship. The difference between the two is the one just stated.

Important Matters Learned from "اِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ"

The verse uses plural forms, such as "we worship only You". This indicates that prayer should be performed in congregation. Another benefit of joining others in worship is that the worship of sinners joins with the worship of beloved and accepted servants of Allah Almighty in the Divine court and attains acceptance. It is also learned that one should express one's servitude in the court of Allah Almighty before presenting one's need. Imam Abdullah ibn Ahmad al-Nasafi رَحْمَةُاللهِ تَعَالٰی عَلَيْهِ states: Worship was mentioned before

seeking help because presenting a means in the court of Allah Almighty before requesting a need is closer to acceptance. (Madarik, Al-Fatihah, under verse 4, p. 14.)

The Blessing of Presenting a Means in the Court of Allah Almighty

Every Muslim should present someone as a means in the court of Allah Almighty and supplicate for one's needs, so that the supplication may be accepted quickly through the blessing of that means. Presenting a means in the court of Allah Almighty is established by the Quran and hadith. Allah Almighty says concerning means:

“یٰۤاَیُّهَا الَّذِیْنَ اٰمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللّٰهَ وَ ابْتَغُوْۤا اِلَیْهِ الْوَسِیْلَةَ” (Al-Ma'idah: 35)

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “O believers! Fear Allah and seek a means of approach towards Him.”

It is mentioned in Sunan Ibn Majah that a blind Companion came to the court of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ seeking supplication. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ instructed him to supplicate as follows: “اَللّٰهُمَّ اِنِّیْ اَسْاَلُکَ وَاَتَوَجَّهُ اِلَیْکَ بِمُحَمَّدٍ نَّبِیِّ الرَّحْمَةِ یَا مُحَمَّدُ اِنِّیْ قَدْ تَوَجَّهْتُ بِکَ اِلٰی رَبِّیْ فِیْ حَاجَتِیْ هٰذِهٖ لِتُقْضٰی اَللّٰهُمَّ فَشَفِّعْهُ فِیَّ”. “O Allah عَزَّوَجَلَّ, I ask You and turn towards You through

Muhammad ﷺ, the Prophet of mercy. O Muhammad ﷺ, I have turned through you towards my Lord concerning this need of mine, so that my need may be fulfilled. O Allah عَزَّوَجَلَّ, accept his intercession for me." (Ibn Majah, Book of Prayer, chapter on what has been narrated concerning the prayer of need, 2/157, hadith 1385.)

Necessary Clarification Concerning the Words "يَا مُحَمَّد" in the Hadith

Imam Ahmad Raza Khan رَحْمَةُاللهِ تَعَالٰی عَلَيْهِ, the highest authority, states: "The scholars explicitly state that calling the Esteemed Presence ﷺ by name is forbidden. This is truly a matter of justice: when the One Who is his Owner and Master, Blessed and Exalted, does not call him by name, what opportunity does a slave have to overstep the path of respect? Rather, Imam Zayn al-Din al-Maraghi and other verifying scholars have stated that if these words occur in a supplication that the Noble Prophet ﷺ himself taught, such as the supplication 'يَا مُحَمَّدُ اِنِّیْ تَوَجَّهْتُ بِکَ اِلٰی رَبِّیْ', one should nevertheless say 'يَا رَسُوْلَ الله' or 'يَا نَبِیَّ الله' in their place, even though supplication wording is not changed as far as

possible. This important matter, of which most people of the age are heedless, must be preserved.” (Fatawa Razawiyyah, 30/157–158.)

{وَ اِیَّاكَ نَسْتَعِیْنُ: And from You alone may we seek help.} This verse states that seeking help, whether through a means or without a means, is exclusive to Allah Almighty, and that He alone is the One from Whom help should truly be sought. Imam Ahmad Raza Khan رَحْمَۃُاللہِ تَعَالٰی عَلَیْہِ states:

“True seeking of help means believing the one from whom help is sought to be inherently powerful, independently sovereign, and self-sufficient, so that he possesses the ability to help through his own essence without Allah Almighty's granting. Holding this belief about anyone besides Allah Almighty is polytheism according to every Muslim. No Muslim holds such a belief concerning anyone besides Allah Almighty. A Muslim believes concerning the accepted servants of Allah that they are a means and intermediary for reaching the Divine court and for needs to be fulfilled.

“Just as true existence, meaning existing through one's own essence without anyone creating one, is exclusive to Allah Almighty, it is not polytheism to call someone existent

unless true existence is intended. Similarly, true knowledge, meaning knowledge possessed through one's own essence without anyone granting it, and true teaching, meaning teaching someone independently without being in need of anything, are exclusive to Allah Almighty. Even so, calling another person knowledgeable or seeking knowledge from him is not polytheism unless those original meanings are intended. The matter of seeking help is the same: its true meaning is exclusive to Allah Almighty, while seeking a means and intermediary is established for others besides Allah Almighty and is correct. Indeed, this meaning is specific to those besides Allah, because Allah Almighty is pure of becoming a means or intermediary. Who is above Him that He would need to be a means to Him, and who besides Him is the true fulfiller of needs that another could become an intermediary between them?

“In answer to an objection raised by people of false beliefs, it is stated: It cannot be that, by making supplication to Allah, He is made into a means and intermediary through someone. We ask the noble saints to become our means,

intermediary, and means of fulfilling needs in the Divine court. Allah Almighty answered this foolish question in the following noble verse:

“وَ لَوْ اَنَّهُمْ اِذْ ظَّلَمُوْۤا اَنْفُسَهُمْ جَآءُوْكَ فَاسْتَغْفَرُوا اللّٰهَ وَ اسْتَغْفَرَ لَهُمُ الرَّسُوْلُ لَوَجَدُوا اللّٰهَ تَوَّابًا رَّحِیْمًا” (An-Nisa: 64)

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “And if, after wronging their souls, they come to you and seek Allah's forgiveness, and the Messenger seeks forgiveness for them, they will surely find Allah Most Accepting of Repentance, Most Merciful.”

Could Allah Almighty not have forgiven them Himself? Then why did He say that they should come to the Prophet, and that he should seek forgiveness for them, so that they would attain this blessing and bounty? This is exactly our point, which the Quranic verse clearly states.” (Fatawa Razawiyyah, 21/304–305, excerpted.)

For further detail concerning this noble verse, study the treatise “بَرَکَاتُ الْاِمْدَادْ لِاَہْلِ الْاِسْتِمْدَادْ” (The Blessings of Assistance for Those Who Seek Assistance) by Imam Ahmad Raza Khan رَحْمَۃُاللہِ تَعَالٰی عَلَیْہِin volume 21 of Fatawa Razawiyyah.

Helping Servants Through Allah Almighty's Grant Is Truly Allah Almighty's Help

Remember that Allah Almighty grants His servants authority to help others. Because of this authority, their helping others is truly Allah Almighty's help. For example, in the Battle of Badr, angels came and helped the noble Companions رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُمْ, yet Allah Almighty said:

“وَ لَقَدْ نَصَرَكُمُ اللّٰهُ بِبَدْرٍ وَّ اَنْتُمْ اَذِلَّةٌ” (Aal-e-Imran: 123)

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “And undoubtedly Allah helped you at Badr when you were completely without resources.”

The angels' help was called Allah Almighty's help because Allah Almighty had granted them the authority to help. Therefore, in reality, it was Allah Almighty's help.

The same applies to the noble Prophets عَلَیْہِمُ الصَّلٰوۃُ وَالسَّلَام and the great saints رَحْمَۃُاللّٰہِ تَعَالٰی عَلَیْہِمْ: they help through Allah Almighty's grant, and in reality that help belongs to Allah Almighty. For example, Sayyiduna Sulayman عَلَیْہِ الصَّلٰوۃُ وَالسَّلَام asked his minister, Sayyiduna Asif ibn Barkhiya رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُ, to bring the throne, and he brought it in the blink of an eye. Sayyiduna Sulayman عَلَیْہِ الصَّلٰوۃُ وَالسَّلَام then said:

“هٰذَا مِنْ فَضْلِ رَبِّیْ”

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “This is from the favour of my Lord.” (An-Naml: 40.)

There are so many examples of helping in the blessed life of the Crown of Messengership ﷺ that a large book could be compiled if they were all gathered. A few examples are as follows:

1. It is mentioned in Sahih Bukhari that the Noble Prophet ﷺ fed the entire army with a small amount of food. (Bukhari, Book of Military Expeditions, chapter on the Battle of the Trench, 3/51–52, hadith 4101; Al-Khasa'is al-Kubra, chapter on his miracles ﷺ in increasing food beyond what has already been mentioned, 2/85.)
2. He ﷺ gave seventy Companions to drink from one bowl of milk. (Bukhari, Book of Heart-Softening Matters, chapter on how the Prophet lived, 4/234, hadith 6452; Umdat al-Qari, Book of Heart-Softening Matters, chapter on how the Prophet lived, 15/536.)
3. He ﷺ caused springs of water to flow from his fingers and gave fourteen hundred, or even more, people to

drink. (Bukhari, Book of Military Expeditions, chapter on the Battle of Hudaybiyyah, 3/69, hadith 4152–4153.)

4. He ﷺ granted many people healing through his blessed saliva. (Al-Khasa'is al-Kubra, chapter on his signs ﷺ in healing the sick, 2/115–118.)

All these acts of help occurred through the power granted by Allah Almighty, so all of them are truly Allah Almighty's help. For further detail, study the treatise "اَلْاَمْنُ وَالْعُلٰی لِنَاعِتِی الْمُصْطَفٰی بِدَافِعِ الْبَلَاءِ" (Rewards for Those Who Call Mustafa Kareem ﷺ the Remover of Affliction) by Imam Ahmad Raza Khan, Imam of Ahl al-Sunnah, عَلَیْہِ رحمۃُ الرَّحْمٰن, in volume 30 of Fatawa Razawiyyah.

Ayat 1:5

Arabic: اِهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيْمَۙ(5)

Translation: Enable us to walk the Straight Path.

{اِهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيْمَ: Enable us to walk the Straight Path.} After mentioning knowledge of Allah Almighty's Essence and attributes, worshipping Him, and His being the true Helper,

a supplication is taught here. A servant should say: “O Allah عَزَّوَجَلَّ, through Your enabling grace You have shown us the straight path; now increase us in guidance towards this path and keep us steadfast upon it.”

Meaning of the Straight Path

The Straight Path means the straight path of beliefs, upon which all the noble Prophets عَلَيْهِمُ الصَّلٰوةُ وَالسَّلَام walked. It may also mean the straight path of Islam, upon which the noble Companions رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُمْ, the righteous elders, and the great saints رَحْمَۃُاللّٰہِ تَعَالٰی عَلَیْہِمْ walked, as is also indicated in the following verse. This is the path of Ahl al-Sunnah, because to this day the noble saints have belonged only to the Ahl al-Sunnah school. Allah Almighty has commanded us to follow their path and remain with them. He says:

“یٰۤاَیُّهَا الَّذِیْنَ اٰمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللّٰهَ وَ كُوْنُوْا مَعَ الصّٰدِقِیْنَ” (At-Tawbah: 119)

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “O believers! Fear Allah and remain with the truthful.”

Sayyiduna Anas رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُ narrates that the Leader of the Messengers ﷺ said, “Indeed, my Ummah will never unite upon misguidance. When you see disagreement, it is

incumbent upon you to remain with the great majority, meaning the great body of Muslims." (Ibn Majah, Book of Tribulations, chapter on the great majority, 4/327, hadith 3950.)

Sayyiduna Abdullah ibn Amr رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُمَا narrates that the Noble Prophet ﷺ said, "The Children of Israel were divided into seventy-two sects, and my Ummah will be divided into seventy-three sects. All of them except one will enter Hell." The noble Companions رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُمْ asked, "O Messenger of Allah ﷺ, which is the saved sect?" He ﷺ said, "The one upon the way upon which I and my Companions are." (Tirmidhi, Book of Faith, chapter on what has been narrated concerning division, 4/291–292, hadith 2650.)

Means of Gaining Guidance

Remember that Allah Almighty has granted many means of gaining guidance. Some of them are:

1. A person's outward and inward abilities, by using which he can gain guidance.

2. The signs in the heavens and the earth that indicate Allah Almighty's power and oneness, through reflecting upon which a person can gain guidance.
3. The Books sent down by Allah Almighty. Before the revelation of the Holy Quran, the Torah, Gospel, and Psalms were means of guidance for people; now the Holy Quran is the means by which people gain guidance.
4. The special servants sent by Allah Almighty, the noble Prophets and great Messengers عَلَيْهِمُ الصَّلٰوةُ وَالسَّلَام. They were means of guidance for their respective nations, while our Prophet Muhammad Mustafa ﷺ is a means of guidance for all people who will come until the Day of Judgement.

Rulings Learned from "اِهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيْمَ"

Three matters are learned from this verse:

1. Every Muslim should supplicate to Allah Almighty for steadfastness upon the straight path, because the straight path leads to the destination, whereas a crooked path does not reach the objective. Allah Almighty states that the intelligent supplicate as follows:

“اِنَّكَ اَنْتَ الْوَهَّابُ-رَبَّنَا لَا تُزِغْ قُلُوْبَنَا بَعْدَ اِذْ هَدَیْتَنَا وَ هَبْ لَنَا مِنْ لَّدُنْكَ رَحْمَةً” (Aal-e-Imran: 8)

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “O our Lord! Do not let our hearts deviate after You have guided us, and grant us mercy from Your presence. Indeed, You are the Great Bestower.”

Sayyiduna Anas رَضِیَ اللّٰہُ تَعَالٰی عَنْہُ states that the Illuminated Presence ﷺ frequently supplicated: “یَا مُقَلِّبَ الْقُلُوْبِ ثَبِّتْ قَلْبِیْ عَلٰی دِیْنِکَ” “O Turner of hearts, keep my heart steadfast upon Your religion.” I asked, “O Messenger of Allah ﷺ, we believe in you and in what you have brought, so do you fear anything concerning us?” The Esteemed Presence ﷺ said, “Yes. Indeed, hearts are between two fingers of the fingers of Allah Almighty, in a manner befitting His majesty; He turns them as He wills.” (Tirmidhi, Book of Divine Decree, chapter on what has been narrated that hearts are, 4/55, hadith 2147.)

1. After worshipping, a servant should engage in supplication.
2. One should not supplicate only for oneself; rather, one should supplicate for all Muslims, because supplication is more readily accepted in this way.

Ayat 1:6

Arabic: صِرَاطَ الَّذِيْنَ اَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ

Translation: The path of those upon whom You have bestowed favour.

{صِرَاطَ الَّذِيْنَ اَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ: The path of those upon whom You have bestowed favour.} This sentence explains the preceding verse: the Straight Path means the path of those upon whom Allah Almighty has bestowed favour and grace. Regarding those upon whom Allah Almighty has bestowed His favour, He says:

“وَ مَنْ يُّطِعِ اللّٰهَ وَ الرَّسُوْلَ فَاُولٰٓىٕكَ مَعَ الَّذِيْنَ اَنْعَمَ اللّٰهُ عَلَيْهِمْ مِّنَ النَّبِيّٖنَ وَ الصِّدِّيْقِيْنَ وَ الشُّهَدَآءِ وَ الصّٰلِحِيْنَۚ وَ حَسُنَ اُولٰٓىٕكَ رَفِيْقًا” (An-Nisa: 69)

Kanz-ul-Irfan translation: “And whoever obeys Allah and the Messenger will be with those upon whom Allah has bestowed favour: the Prophets, the truthful, the martyrs, and the righteous; and what excellent companions they are!”

Matters Learned from “صِرَاطَ الَّذِيْنَ اَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ”

Two matters are learned from this verse:

1. Matters upon which the righteous elders have acted are included in the Straight Path.
2. Imam Fakhr al-Din al-Razi رَحْمَۃُاللہِ تَعَالٰی عَلَیْہِ states: Some exegetes have said that mentioning "صِرَاطَ الَّذِیْنَ اَنْعَمْتَ عَلَیْهِمْ" after "اِهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِیْمَ" proves that a disciple can reach the stations of guidance and spiritual unveiling only when he follows a perfect spiritual guide who guides him towards the correct path and protects him from places of error and misguidance. Since deficiency dominates most people and their intellects are unable to understand truth and distinguish right from wrong, it is necessary to have a perfect person whom an imperfect person follows, until the light of the perfect person's intellect strengthens the imperfect person's intellect as well. In this way, he can reach the degrees of felicity and the heights of perfection. (Tafsir Kabir, Al-Fatihah, third section, 1/164.)

{غَیْرِ الْمَغْضُوْبِ عَلَیْهِمْ وَ لَا الضَّآلِّیْنَ: Not of those who were subjected to wrath nor of the astray ones.} Those subjected to Allah Almighty's wrath refer to the Jews, and the astray refer to the Christians, as mentioned in Sunan al-Tirmidhi, volume 4, page 444, hadith 2964. Imam Fakhr al-Din al-Razi رَحْمَۃُاللہِ

عَلَیْہِ تَعَالٰی also wrote that those subjected to wrath refer to people of evil deeds, while the astray refer to people of corrupt beliefs. (Tafsir Kabir, Al-Fatihah, under verse 7, 1/222–223.) Every Muslim should remain separate from the Jews, Christians, and all disbelievers in beliefs, deeds, character, appearance, and every other respect. He should neither adopt their ways, customs, and fashions nor maintain their friendships and company. He should consider the happiness of both worlds to lie in moulding himself according to the Quran and Sunnah. [1]

The Islamic Ruling Concerning "وَ لَا الضَّآلِّیْنَ"

Some people recite "وَلَا الضَّآلِّیْنَ" as "وَلَا الظَّآ لِّیْن". This is forbidden. Imam Ahmad Raza Khan رَحْمَۃُاللہِ تَعَالٰی عَلَیْہِ states: "ض، ظ، ذ، ز are all distinct and different letters, meaning letters separate from one another. Deliberately replacing one of them with another during Quranic recitation, whether in prayer or outside prayer, is categorically forbidden and a great sin; it is fabricating against Allah and altering the Noble Book." (Fatawa Razawiyyah, 6/305.) For detailed information with proofs, study these treatises in volume six of Fatawa Razawiyyah: (1) "نِعْمَ الزَّادْ لِرَوْمِ الضَّادْ" (The

best provision for pronouncing Dad); and (2) "اِلْجَامُ الصَّادْ عَنْ سُنَنِ الضَّادْ" (A discussion of the correct and incorrect ways of pronouncing Dad).

{اٰمین} One meaning is: "O Allah عَزَّوَجَلَّ, accept it." Another meaning is: "O Allah عَزَّوَجَلَّ, make it so."

Islamic Rulings Concerning Ameen

1. Ameen is not a word of the Holy Quran.
2. Whenever Surah Al-Fatihah is completed inside or outside prayer, saying Ameen afterwards is Sunnah.
3. According to the Hanafi school, Ameen is not said aloud in prayer; rather, it is said quietly.

[1] Becoming affiliated with Dawat-e-Islami, the global, non-political movement for spreading the Quran and Sunnah, is extremely beneficial for striving to reform oneself and people throughout the world.

Ayat 1:7

Arabic: غَيْرِ الْمَغْضُوْبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَ لَا الضَّآلِّيْنَ(7)

Translation: Not of those who were subjected to (Your) wrath nor of the astray ones.